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My Profile

My Journal

Friends

# TUMBLE STACK

CSCI 3308 • Team Project

# Initial Concept

Our concept began with one question: how can we make journaling easier and more enjoyable for people who struggle to stay consistent?

## What We Noticed

- Many young users find traditional journaling difficult to stay consistent with.
- Social media feels too public for personal thoughts.
- There's no simple platform for friends to share reflections privately.
- Users want a low-pressure space to express themselves and connect.

# Our Vision

To create a journaling experience that's easy, approachable for users, and enjoyable to use.

## User Needs

- A low-pressure, private space to express themselves.
- Prompts and motivation to journal consistently.
- A fun, approachable interface designed for younger audiences.
- A way to share reflections with close friends in a safe way.

## Key Features

- Daily journal prompts
- Personal + shared journal entries
- Friend system with requests
- Clean, minimal interface for writing
- Secure login + registration

# Phase Structure

A four-phase process that guided our team from initial brainstorming to a fully functional journaling application.

## Phase 1

- Brainstormed initial ideas.
- Identified user needs and common issues with traditional journaling.
- Defined the core purpose and vision.

## Phase 2

- Created wireframes and user flows
- Chose the color palette, UI style, and layout.
- Outlined the features: prompts, journals, friends, authentication.

## Phase 3

- Built backend structure
- Developed frontend pages for prompts, journals, profiles, friends.
- Integrated frontend + backend to create full functionality.

## Phase 4

- Debugged features and fixed integration issues.
- Finalized a polished, user-friendly version of the app.

# Who Uses Tumble Stack?

Designed for users who want a simple, motivating, and low-pressure journaling experience.

## Target Audience

- College & high school students who want to reflect on their day.
- Younger users who find traditional journaling boring or hard to keep up with.
- Friends who want a more meaningful way to stay connected than social media.
- People who like writing but want something low-pressure and digital.



# Engagement Strategy

Tumble Stack engages users by offering three fresh daily prompts, letting them choose what they want to reflect on. This reduces writer's block, makes journaling feel fun, and encourages consistent writing without pressure.

## Pick your prompt for today

Wednesday, December 3, 2025

What songs or shows have you been enjoying lately? Why?

Answer

What made you laugh today?

Answer

What do you think the title of your memoir would be? Why?

Answer

# Frontend Challenges

These challenges highlight what we learned while creating the user interface.

- Developing smooth dev workflow
- Learning Handlebars + moving away from pure HTML
- Making image rendering work properly
- Fixing spacing + layout inconsistencies
- Solving random auto-refresh issues

# Backend Challenges

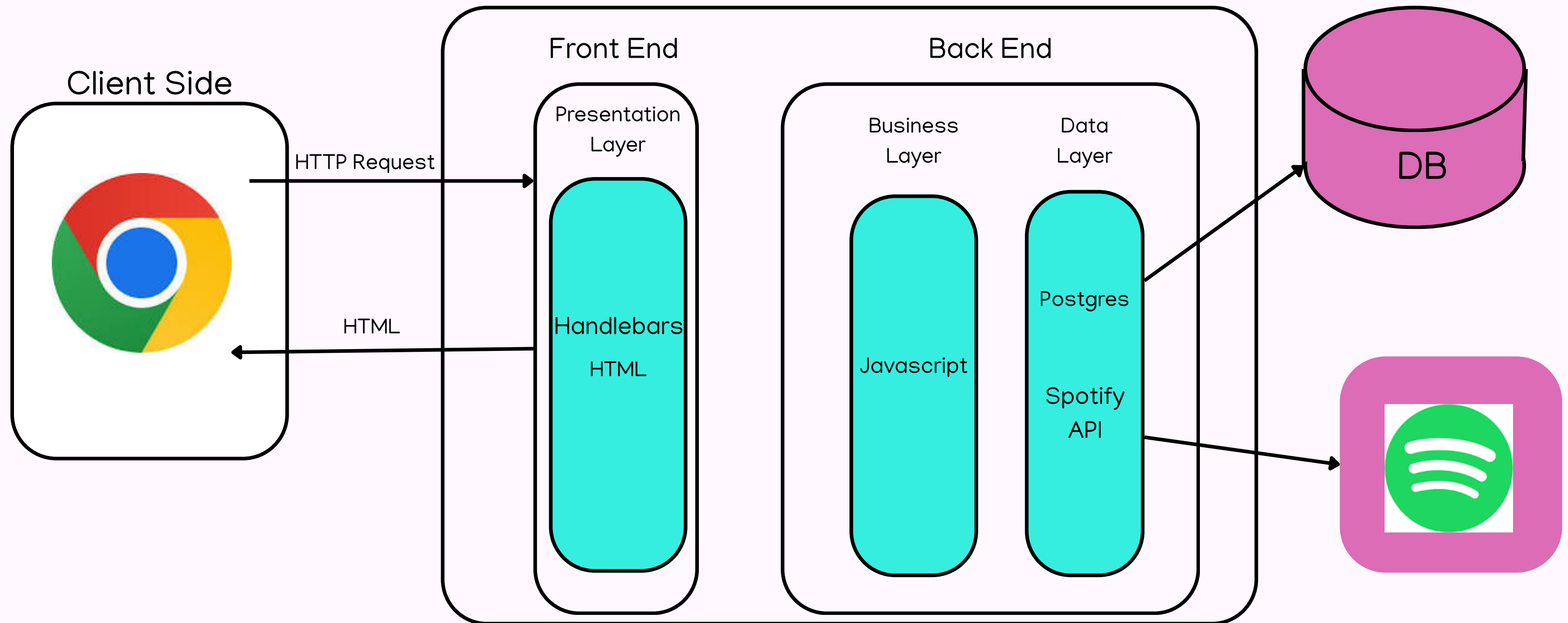
Our backend challenges centered around user relationship logic, API integration, and structuring data to support multiple types of journal entries.

- mutual friending
- spotify connection
- storing different journal entries into the database



# Architecture Diagram

## Server Side



# Tech Stack

Tools we used to build our application

## Development

- |                           | <u>Rating</u> |
|---------------------------|---------------|
| • Node.js + Express       | 5/5 ★         |
| • PostgreSQL              | 5/5 ★         |
| • Handlebars              | 5/5 ★         |
| • HTML / CSS / JavaScript | 5/5 ★         |
| • Docker & docker-compose | 5/5 ★         |

## Collaboration & Design

- |                                    | <u>Rating</u> |
|------------------------------------|---------------|
| • Git & GitHub for version control | 5/5 ★         |
| • VS Code                          | 5/5 ★         |
| • Canva / slides for UI mockups    | 5/5 ★         |
| • Discord                          | 3/5 ★         |

# Enhancements

Throughout development, we identified several potential enhancements that could improve usability, increase personalization, and support long-term engagement across a wider range of users.

- Comment replies
- Custom or saved prompts
- Mood tracking & visual summaries
- Push notifications for daily prompts
- Tagging + searchable entries

# Demonstration

The screenshot shows a web browser window with the address bar displaying "group-project-015-03.onrender.com/register". The page has a light pink background. At the top, a green message box states "Username already exists. Try a different one." Below this, the heading "Register here!" is followed by the subtext "Make an account so you can start journaling!". There are two input fields: "Username" with the letter "I" entered, and "Password" which is currently empty. A blue "Register" button is positioned below the fields. At the bottom, a link reads "Already have an account? [Login here!](#)".